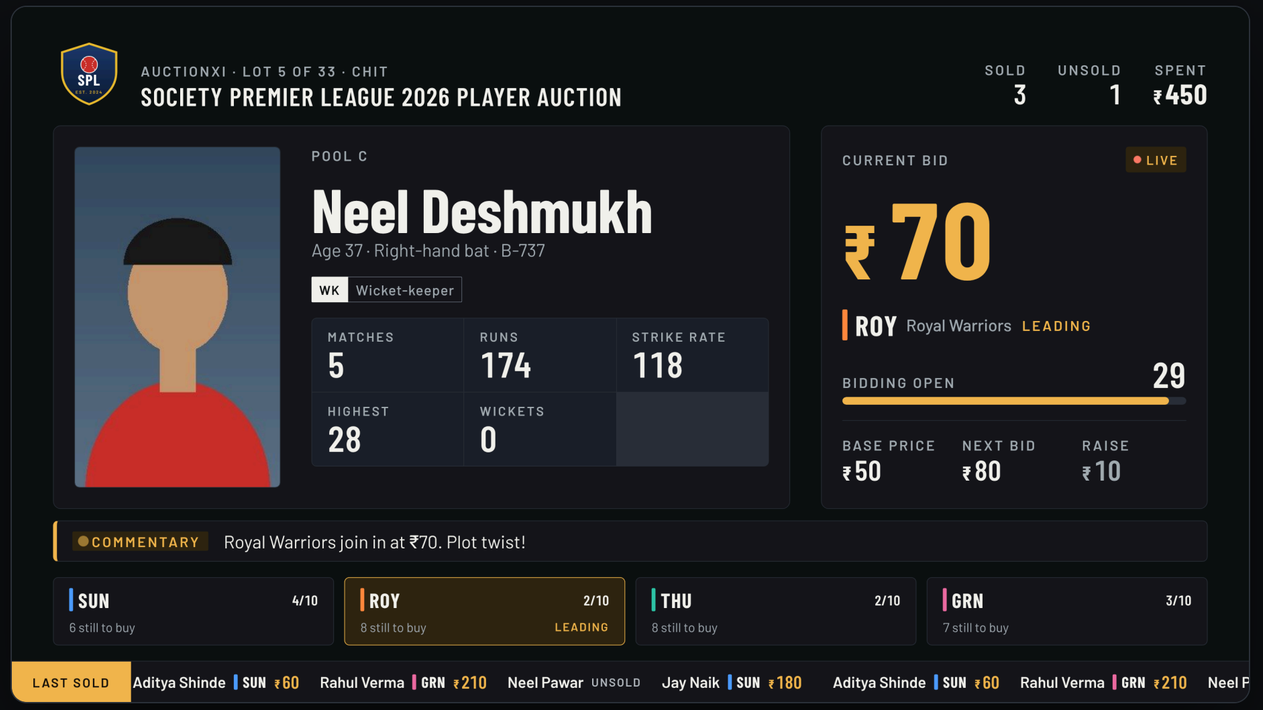
HOW TO USE AUCTIONXI

Organiser and captain guide

Every feature, and how to use it: setting up and running the auction, and bidding and planning as a captain.

Free and open source · pareshzawar.github.io/AuctionXI

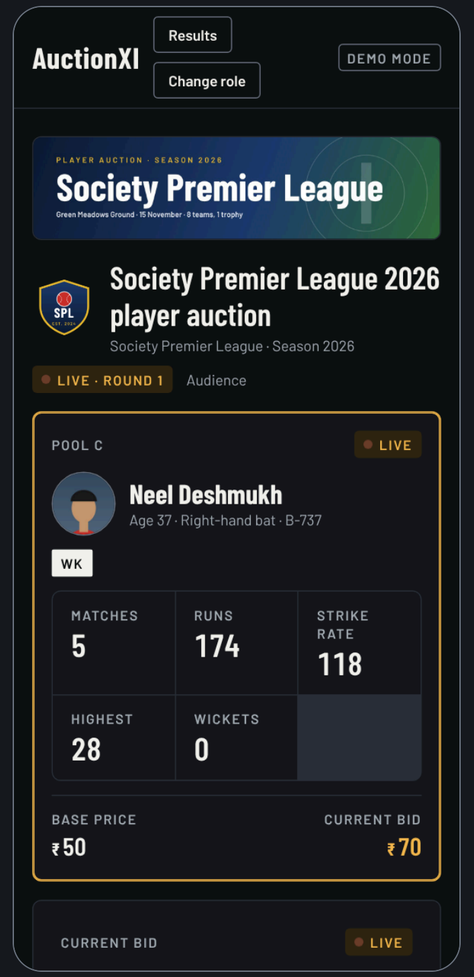


WHO DOES WHAT

One auction, a screen for every role

ROLE	HOW THEY GET IN	WHAT THEY DO
Admin (organiser)	Creates the auction (Google sign-in keeps it on your other devices)	Setup, teams, players, sharing, control room, results. **Part A**
Co-admin	Admin code	Runs the control room on a second laptop
Captain	Own team code	Bids on the phone, private workbook and budget plan. **Part B**
Vice-captain	Own code, if allowed	Same as the captain, when the tournament lets both bid
Members, audience	Auction code or link	Follow live: player, bids, squads, commentary, player profiles
Stage screen	Stage link	Projector in the hall, or shared on Zoom / Meet

> Signing in with Google never makes anyone an admin of *your* auction: only its creator and people you give the admin code. Part C is the auction-day checklist.



PART A

For organisers

Create the auction, set the rules, add teams and players, share it, rehearse, run it, and publish the results.

What you need

1. Setup questionnaire

tournament_setup_template.csv: name, date, venue, purse, squad size, captain / vice-captain values, pools and base prices, bid steps, house rules. Fill it in with your committee.

2. Teams

teams_template.csv: team name, short name, colour, and optionally captain, vice-captain and owner.

3. Players

players_template.csv: name, role, pool, batting hand, bowling arm and type, stats, notes, CricHeroes link, and the **list** column (blank, *waiting* or *cancelled*).

Templates

In the repo's **templates/** folder, or the download buttons in each tab.

Photos

Player photos, a league logo and a banner (any shape, nothing is cropped).

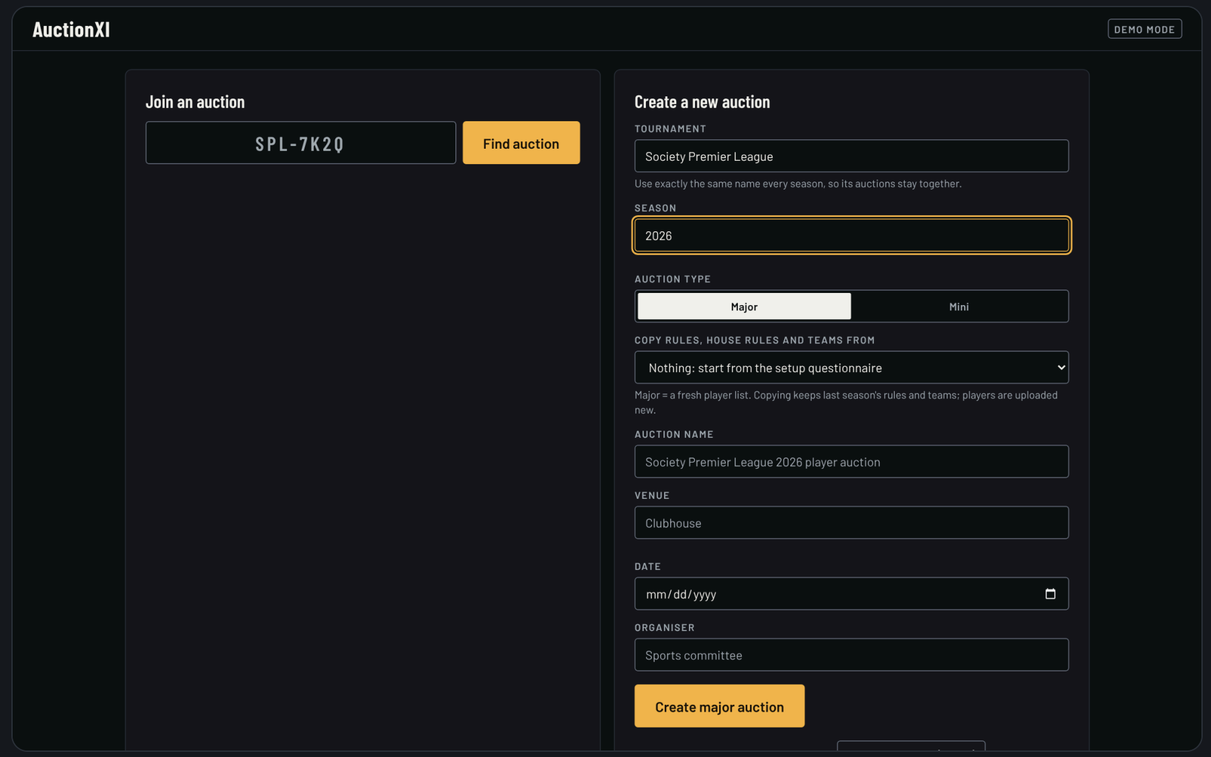
Once

Connect your free Firebase project and publish the database rules (docs/SETUP.md).

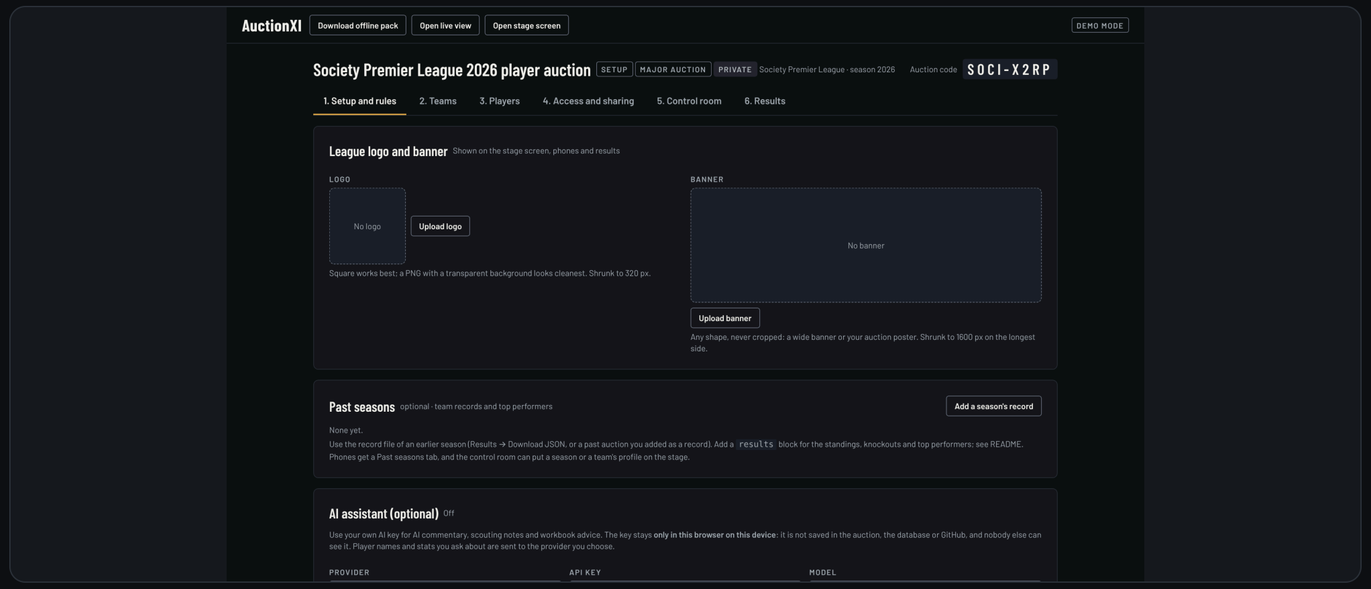
Start a new auction from the home page

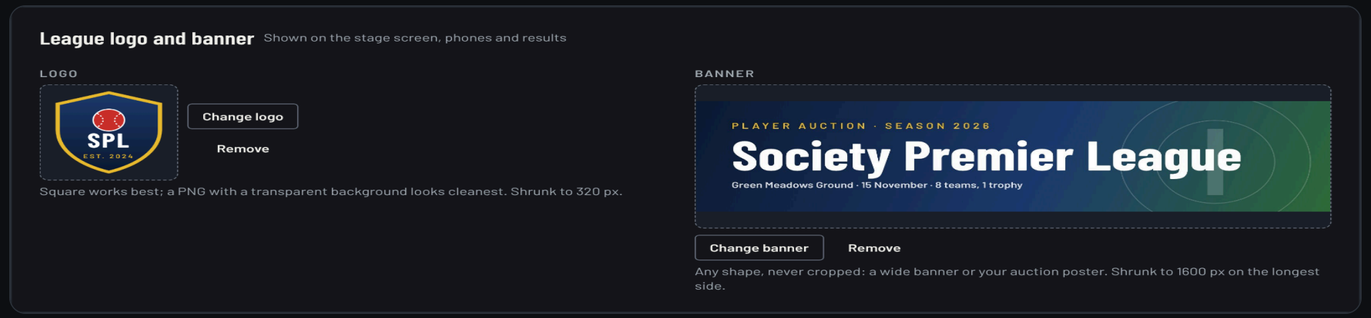
1. Open the site and fill in **Create a new auction**: tournament, season, venue and date.
2. Choose **Major** (a fresh player list) or **Mini** (built from last season: keep some players, release the rest).
3. Press **Create**. You are now the admin of this auction on this browser.
4. It starts **Private**: nobody else can see it until you share it (A9).

> Past auctions can be added as a record too: *Add a past auction (record)* on the home page.



Rules from one questionnaire, plus logo and banner

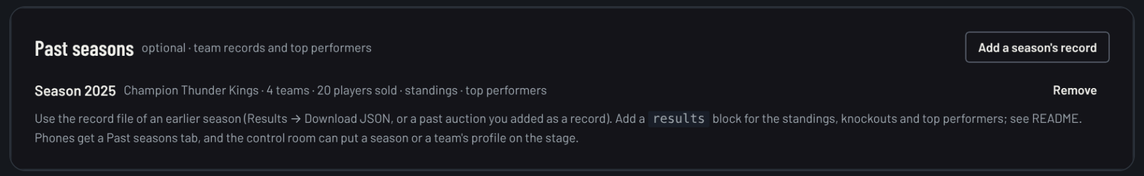


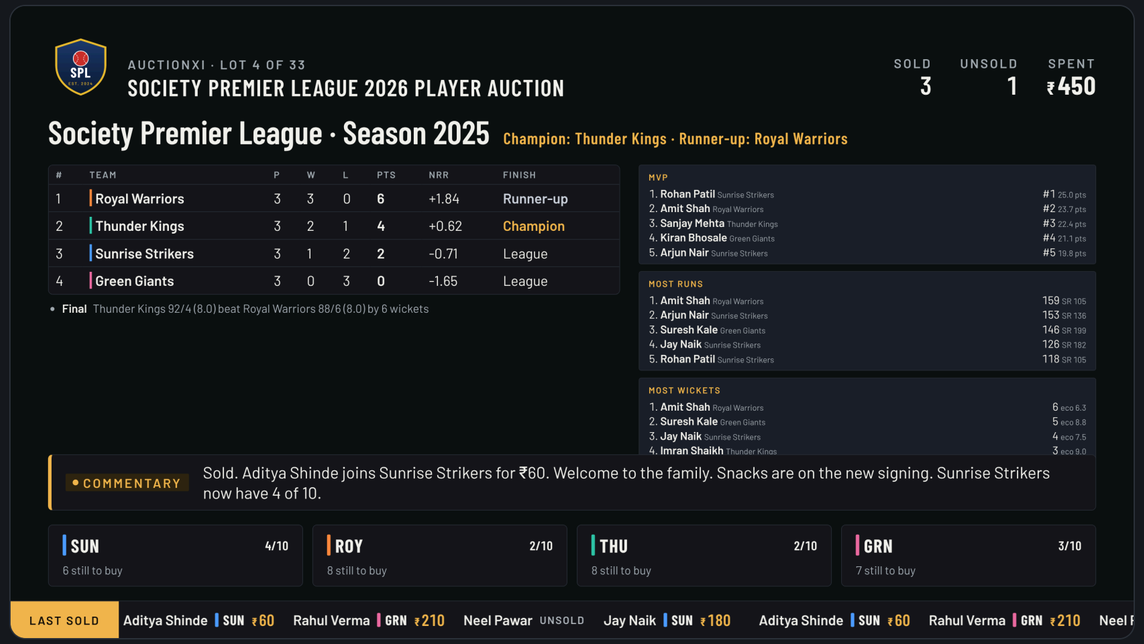


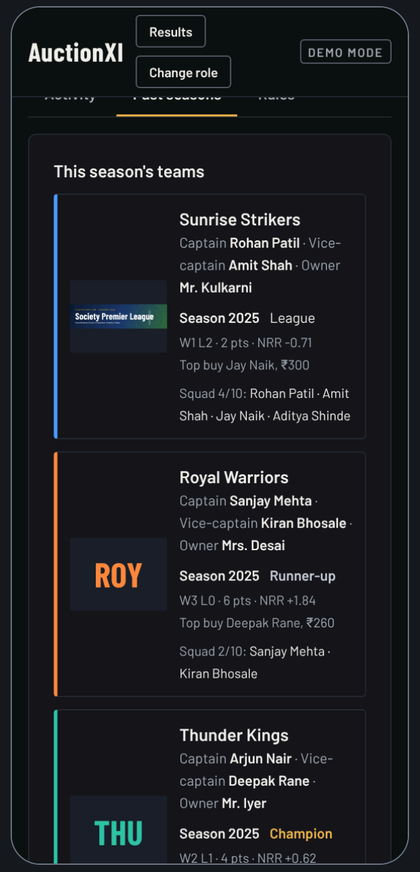
1. **Setup → Fill the setup from a questionnaire**: upload the filled CSV. Every answer lands in the form below.
2. Check the sections: tournament, purse and squad, captain and vice-captain, pools and base prices, bid increments, bidding, house rules. Change anything and **Save**.
3. **League logo and banner**: upload them; they appear on the stage, phones, slides and results.

> Max bid = points left − (players still to buy − 1) × base price, so every team can always fill its squad.

Last season's table, top performers and every team's record

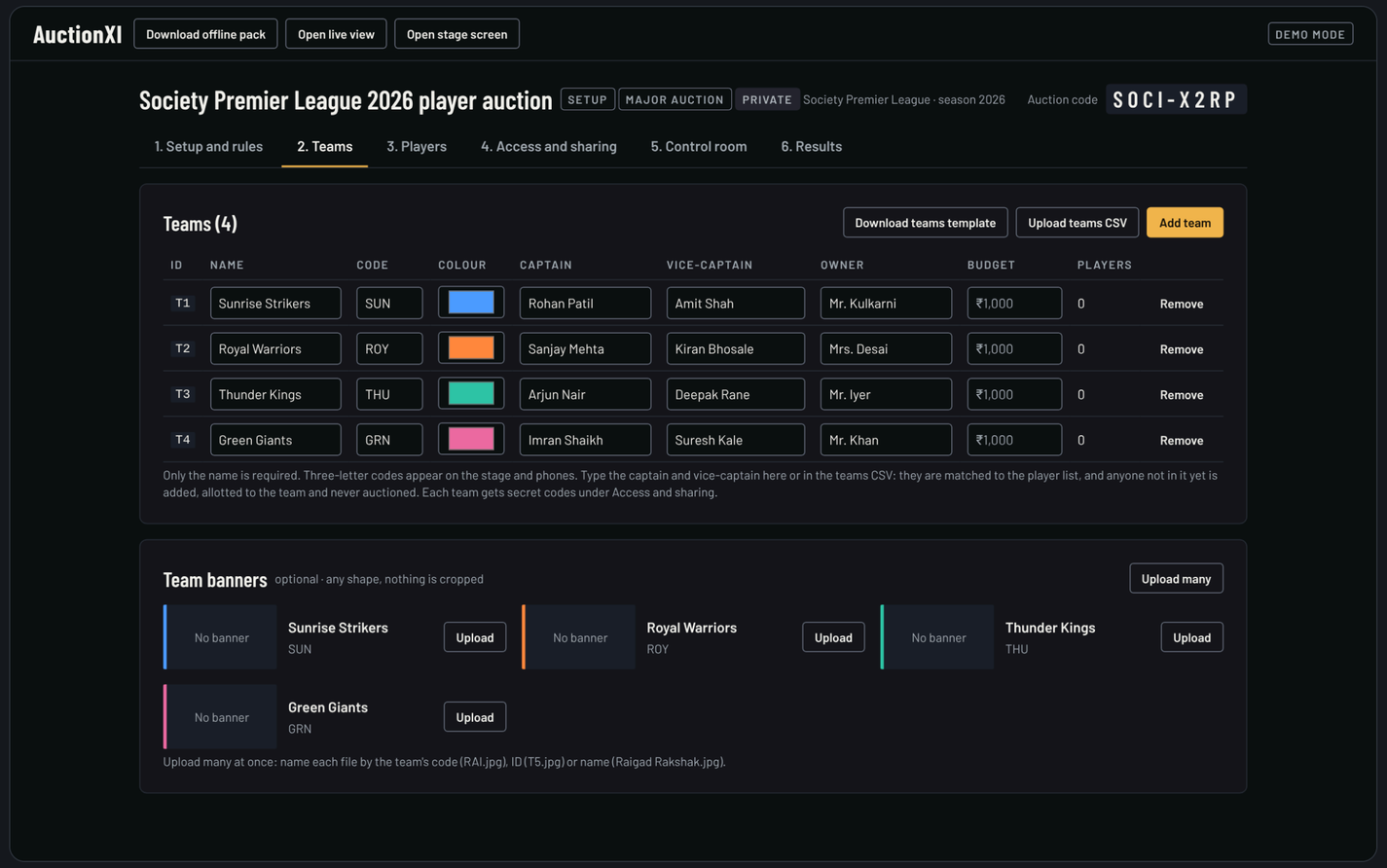






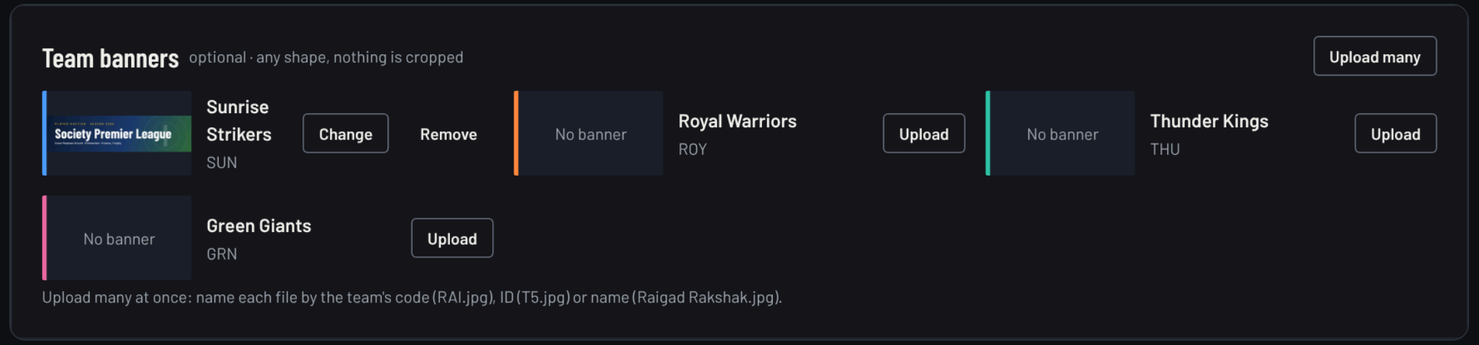
1. **Setup → Past seasons → Add a season's record**: the record file of an earlier season.
2. Add a `results` block (README) for the final table, knockouts, champion and top performers.
3. Phones get a **Past seasons** tab; each team shows what it did before, even if its name was spelt differently.
4. Control room → On the stage → **Season record** puts it on the projector.

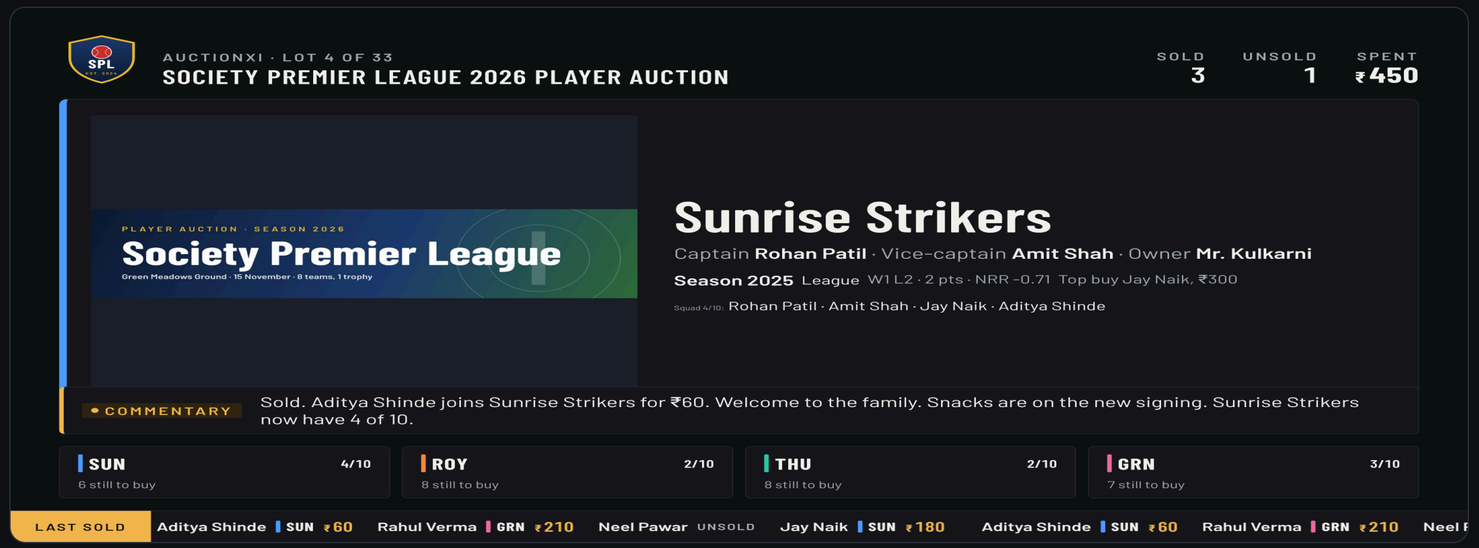
Upload the teams with their captains



1. **Teams → Upload** the teams CSV, or add teams by hand.
2. Captain, vice-captain and owner are **optional**. Use the same spelling as in the players list, so they are matched.
3. Captains and vice-captains are put in their teams at their value when the auction starts; they are never auctioned.

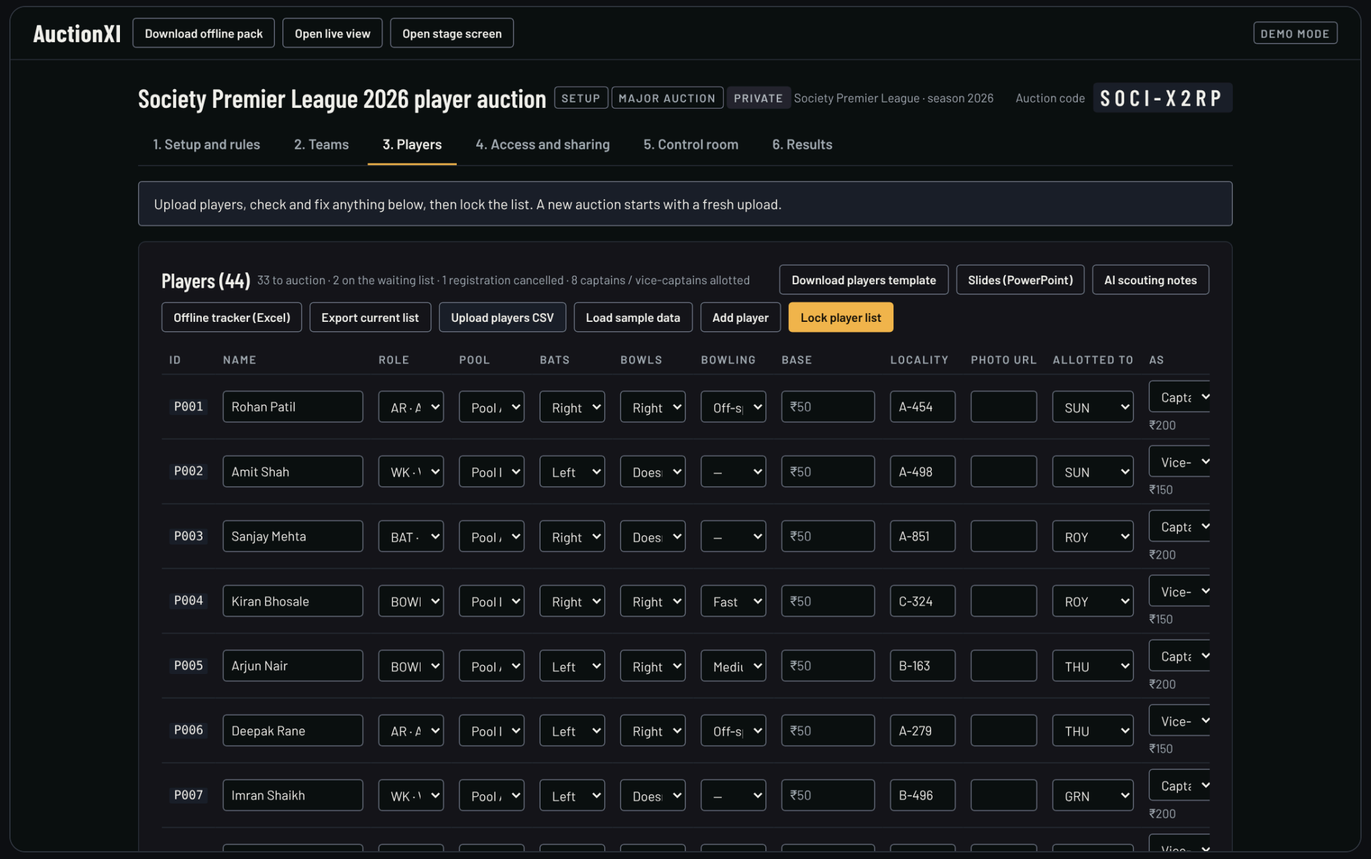
A banner for every team, and its profile on the stage





1. **Teams → Team banners**: upload one at a time, or many at once named by team code (`RAI.jpg`).
2. Phones show the banner above the team's squad.
3. Control room → On the stage → **A team's profile**: banner, captain, vice-captain, squad so far and past seasons.

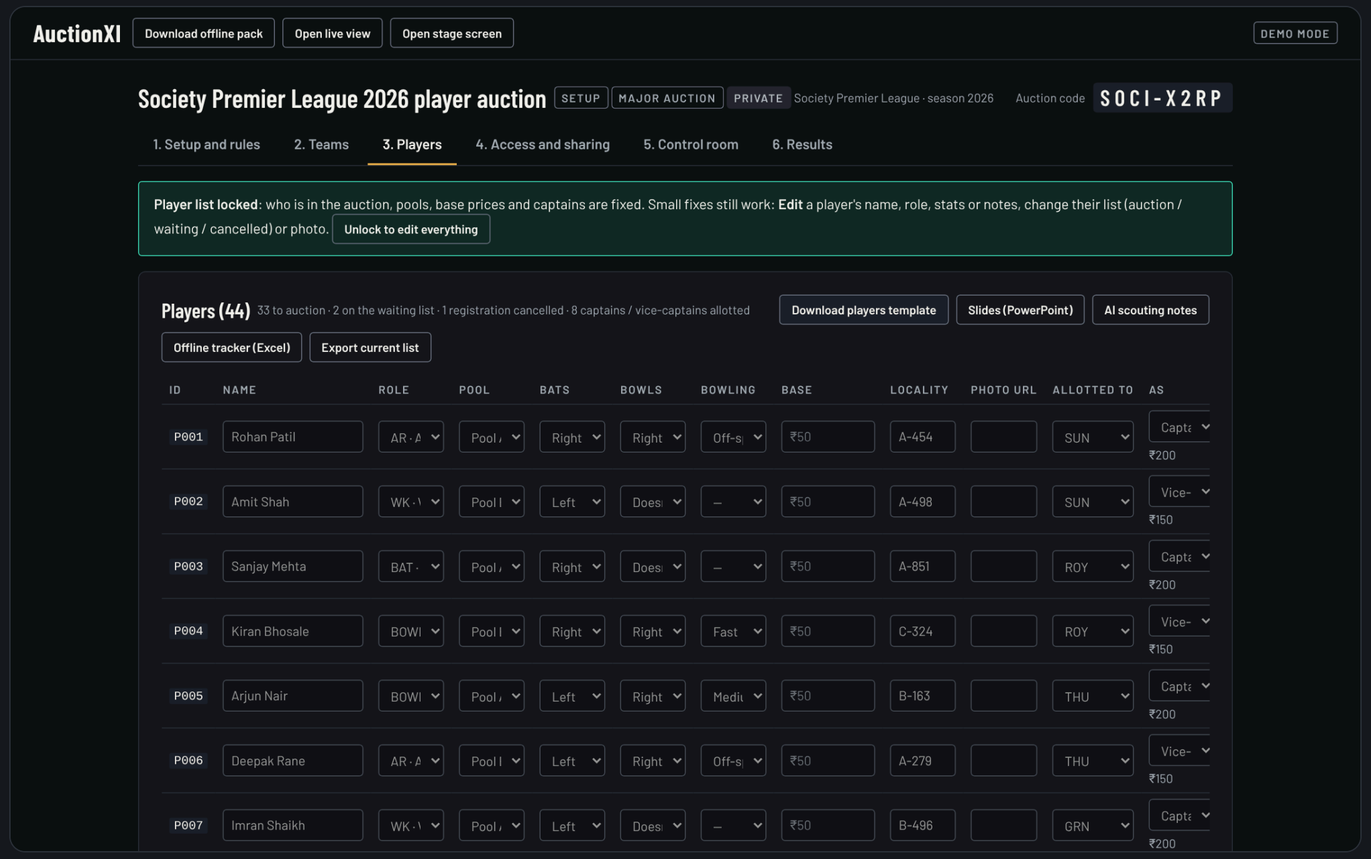
Upload, check, choose each player's list, then lock



1. **Players → Upload** the players CSV. Fix anything flagged, or edit in the table.
2. **List** column for each player: **Auction**, **Waiting list** or **Registration cancelled**. Works even after locking (except for the player up for bidding).
3. **Player photos**: one at a time, or many at once named by player number or full name.
4. **Lock** the list when it is final.

> Waiting-list players come in only if you move them to Auction. Cancelled players stay on record but are left out of the auction, lists and downloads.

Locking fixes the list, not the spelling



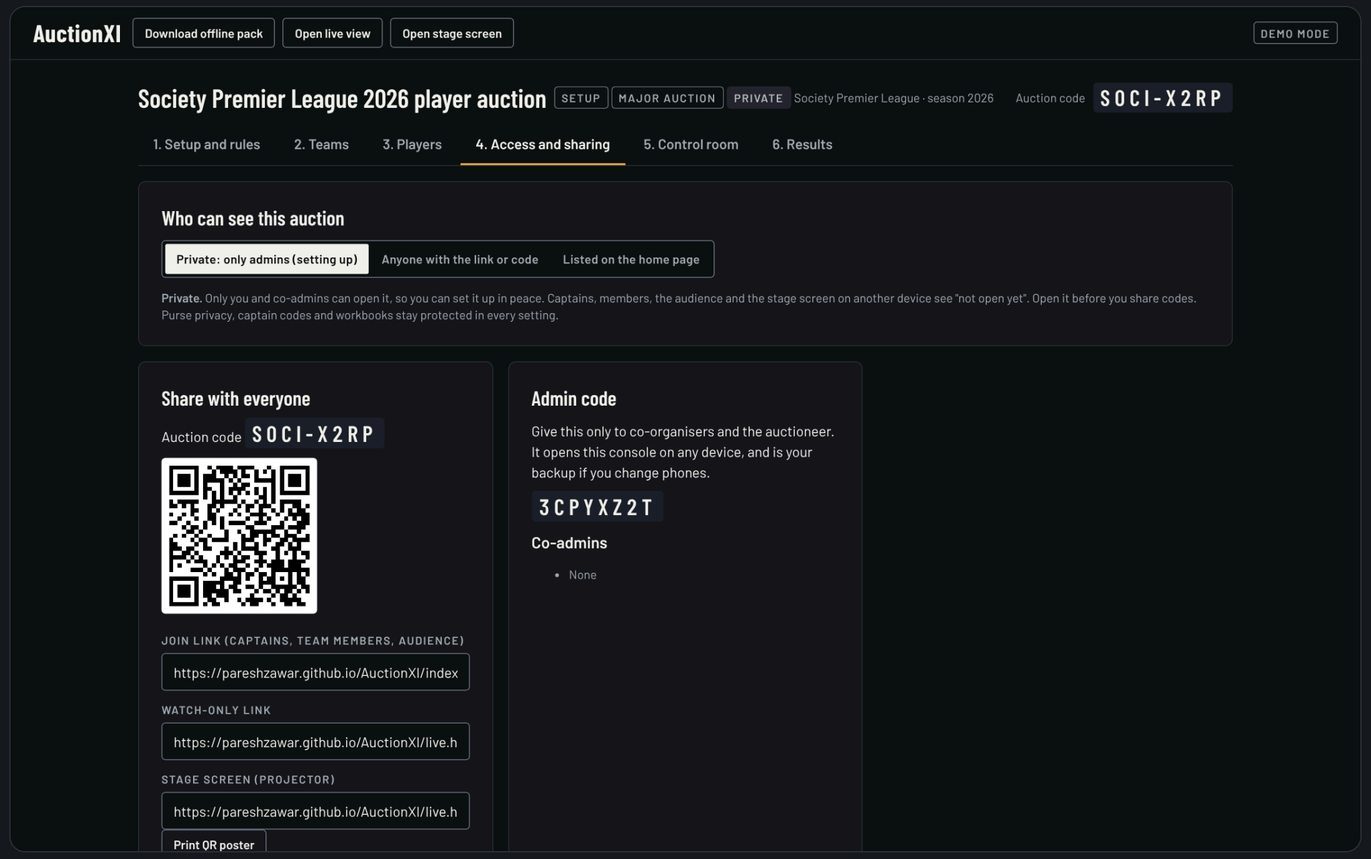


AFTER LOCKING

Fixed	Who is in the auction, pools, base prices, captains
Still editable	**Edit**: name, role, stats, notes. Also the list and photos

> Every change saves at once and says so (✓ saved). Unlock any time before the start; starting locks it for good.

Private while you set up, then share it



WHO CAN SEE	MEANING
Private	Only admins. Use it while setting up.
Link or code	Anyone with the link, QR or auction code.
Listed	Also shown on the home page.

1. Send each captain (and vice-captain) **their own code**, privately.
2. **Admin code** lets a co-admin run the control room on another laptop.
3. **Present on Zoom or Meet**: open the stage link and share that tab.

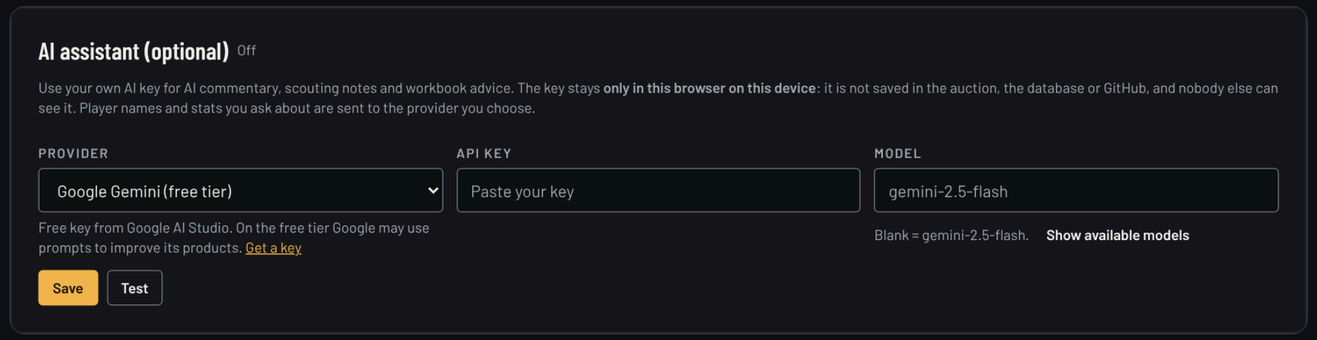
A poster for the club house, in one click

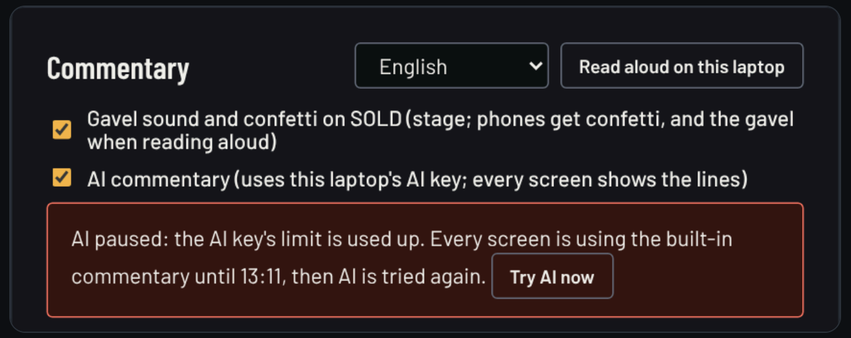


1. **Access and sharing → Print QR poster.**
2. A4 or A3; dark like the stage, or light to save ink.
3. It uses your banner, logo, date, venue, teams and auction code, and a big QR code that opens the auction.
4. Print at 100% with no margins, or save as PDF and send it on WhatsApp.

> Pin one at the gate, one in the hall and one near the projector. The QR code is drawn on the laptop, so it works offline.

Use a free AI key for commentary and scouting notes

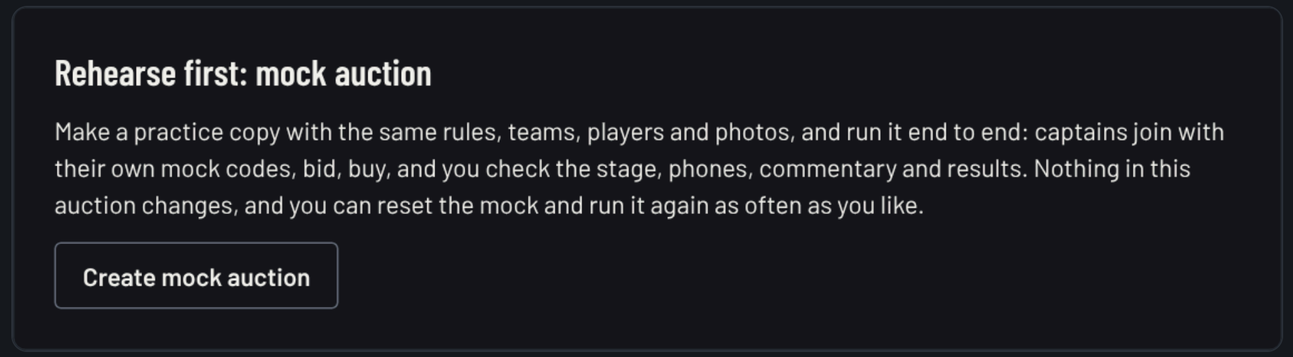




1. **Setup → AI assistant**: choose Google Gemini (free key from AI Studio), Groq, OpenRouter, Claude or any compatible service.
2. Paste your key and press **Test**. The key stays only in this browser: never in the database or on GitHub.
3. **AI commentary**: tick it in the control room. If the AI is slow, the built-in line is used.
4. **Scouting notes**: Players → AI button writes a note per player from the stats; you review before saving.

> If the key's limit runs out or the AI is down, every screen switches to the built-in commentary by itself, and AI comes back when it works again.

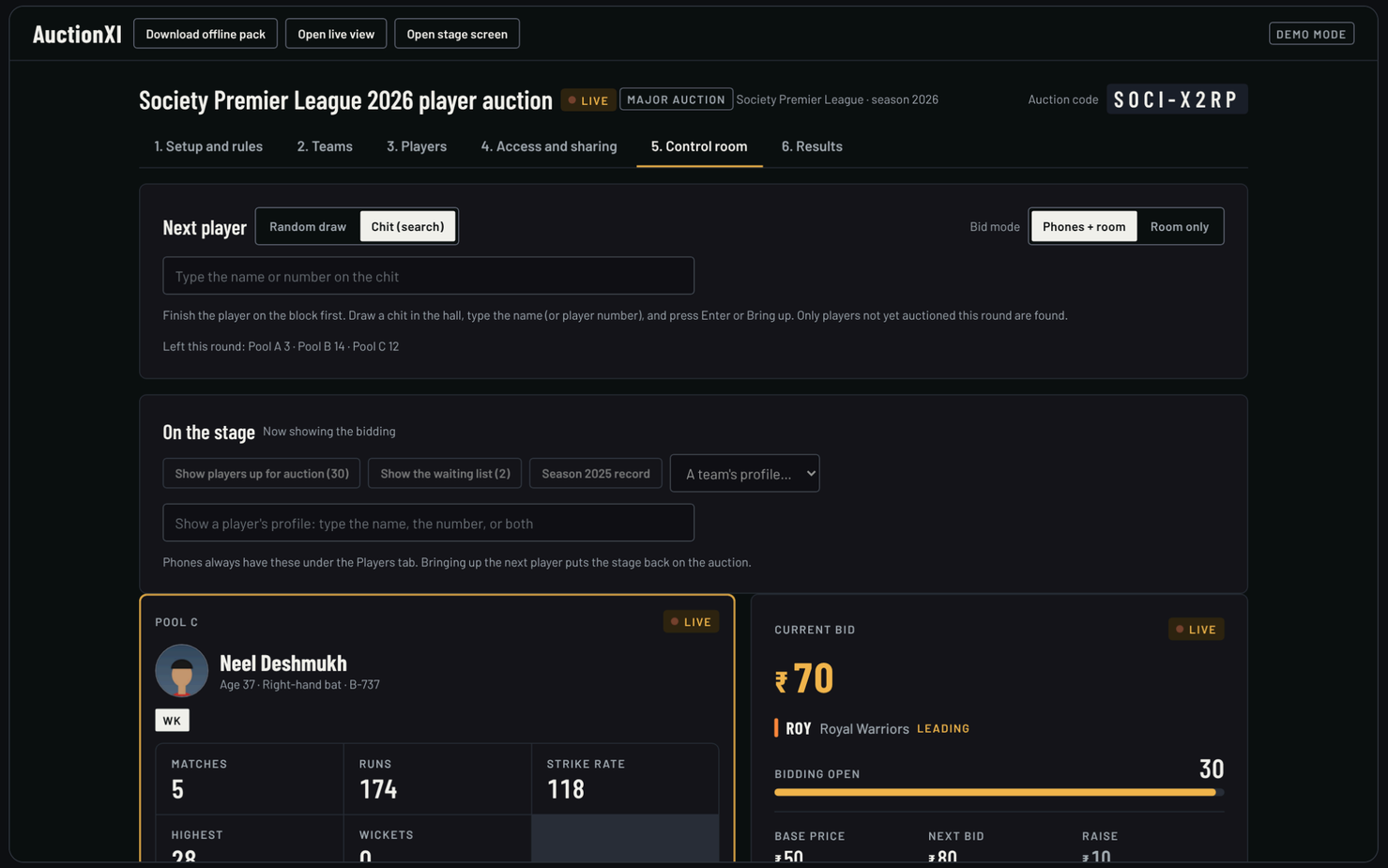
Run a mock auction first



A mock is a practice copy with the same rules, teams, players and photos, and its own codes. Reset it or delete it when done; the real auction is untouched.

1. Control room → **Create mock auction**.
2. Give captains the mock codes and check every phone can join and bid.
3. Open the stage on the projector; check the commentary and voice.
4. Sell a few players, try unsold and undo, download the slides and the tracker.
5. **Reset** or **Delete** the mock, then run the real one.

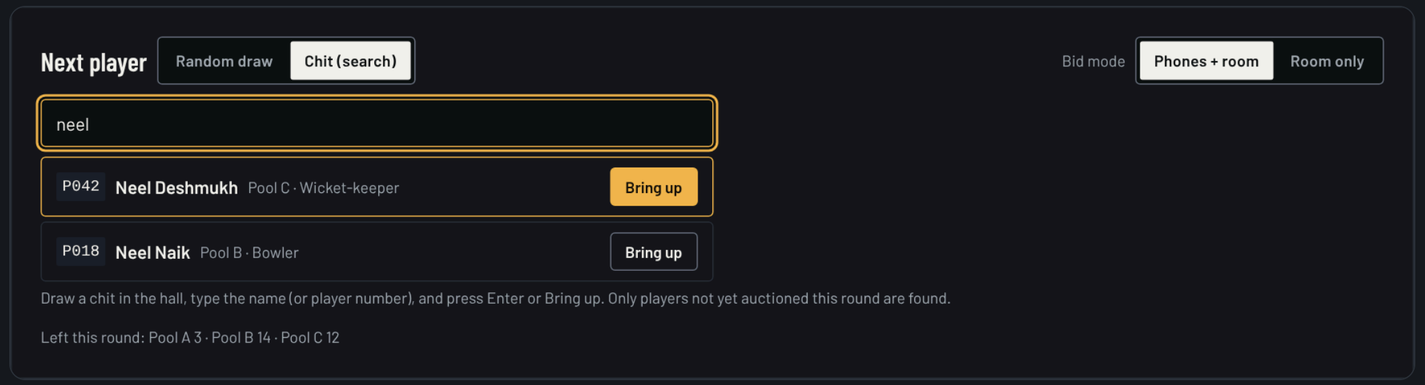
Run the auction from the laptop



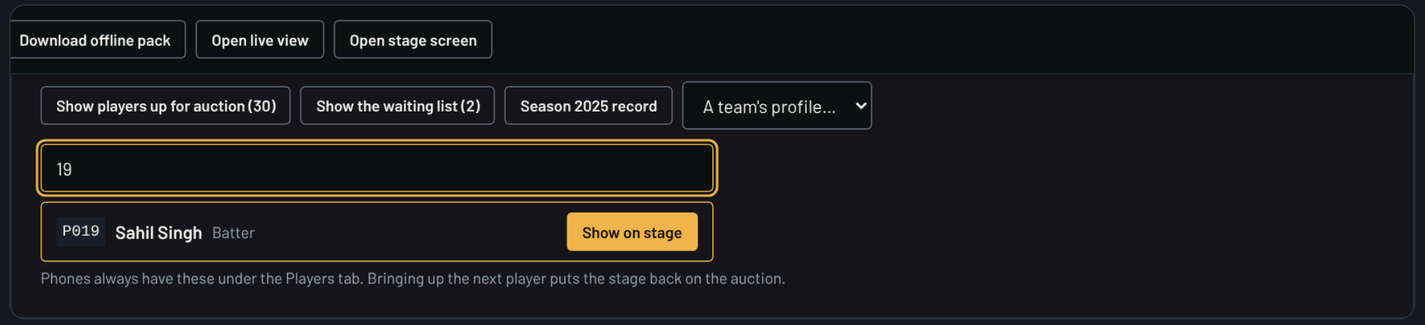
1. **Start the auction**: captains and vice-captains go into their teams.
2. **Next player**: random draw (by pool or role), or a chit from the bowl (A14).
3. Bids come from phones, or click a team for a room bid.
4. **Mark sold** or **Unsold**. Undo fixes mistakes.

KEY	DOES
N	Next player / chit search
1 – 8	Room bid for that team
S U	Sold · Unsold
Z	Undo last bid

Search by name, by number, or both



Next player → Chit: type what is on the chit and press Enter to bring them up.

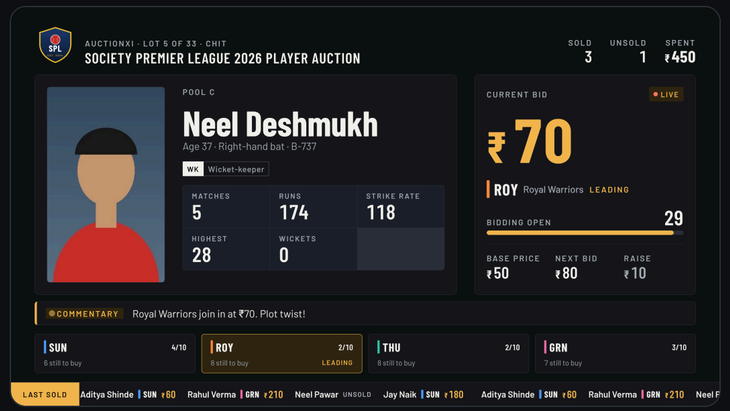


On the stage: show a player's profile on the big screen.

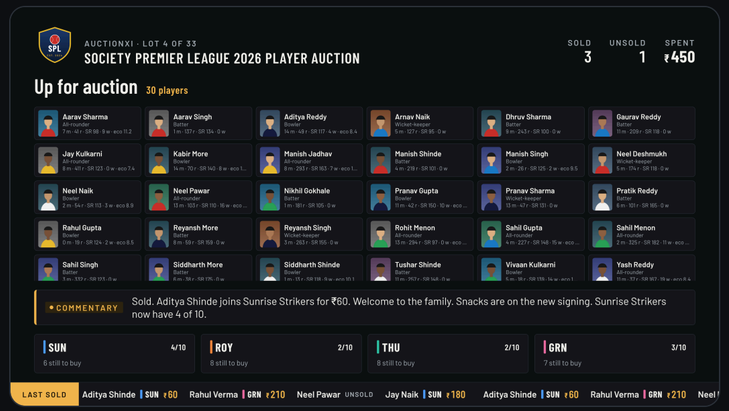
TYPE	FINDS
aadesh	Every name with Aadesh
24 or P024	Player number 24
24 aadesh	Both must match

> The same search is on phones (Players tab), in the captain's workbook, and in the Excel tracker's **Find Player** sheet.

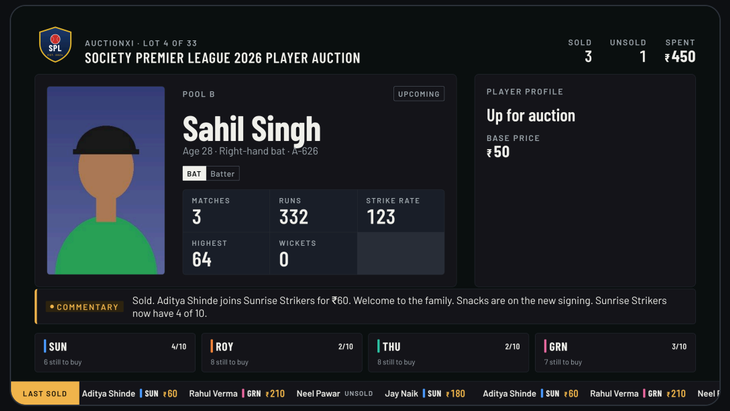
The projector and the video call



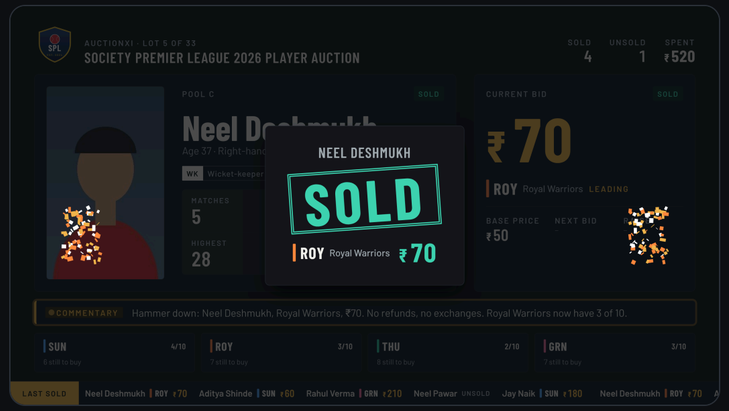
Bidding: photo, stats, bid, countdown, squads



Players up for auction or the **waiting list**, 30 at a time

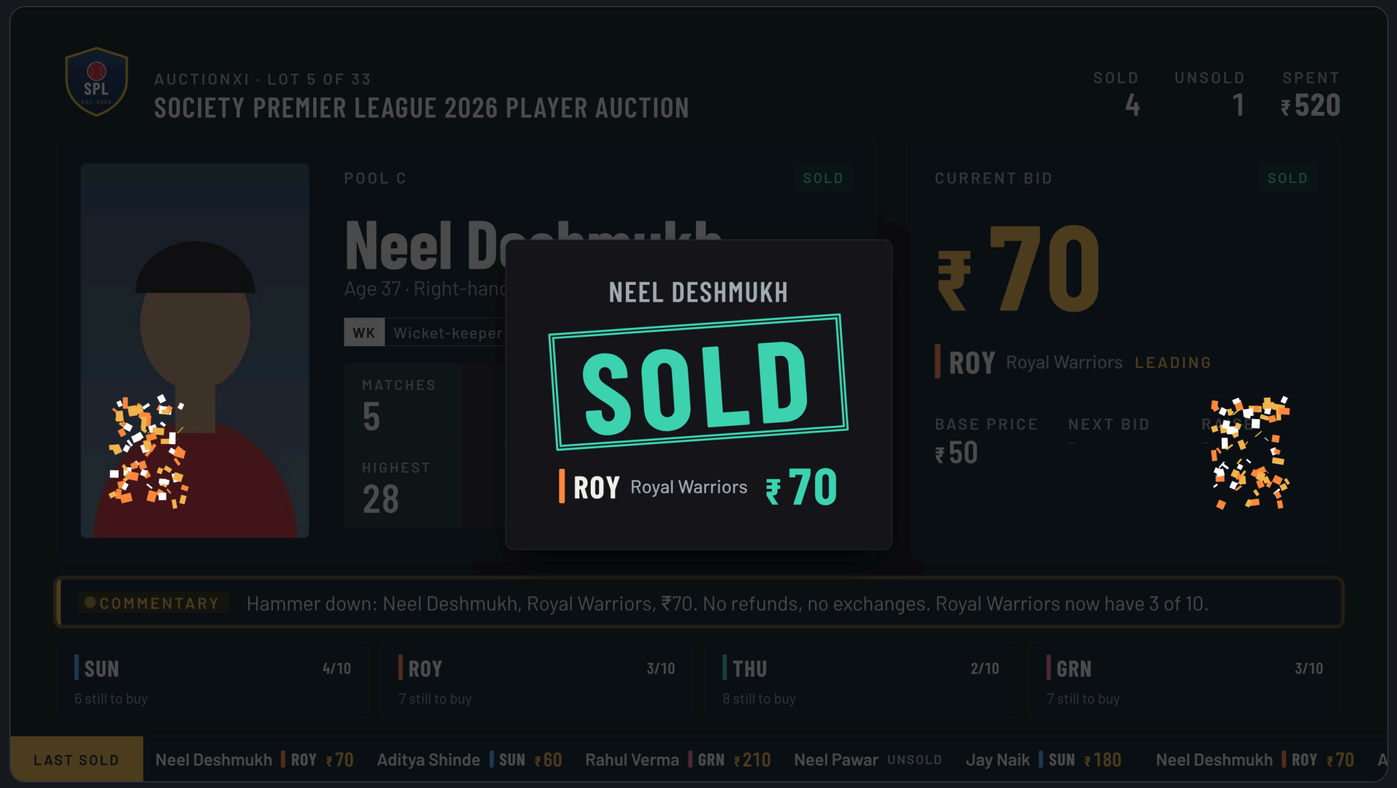


A player's profile, any time outside bidding



SOLD. Commentary: a gold box, a shine every 90 s

Make the hall cheer



SOLD: the stamp, a gavel (going, going, gone; one more knock for a record) and confetti in the buying team's colours

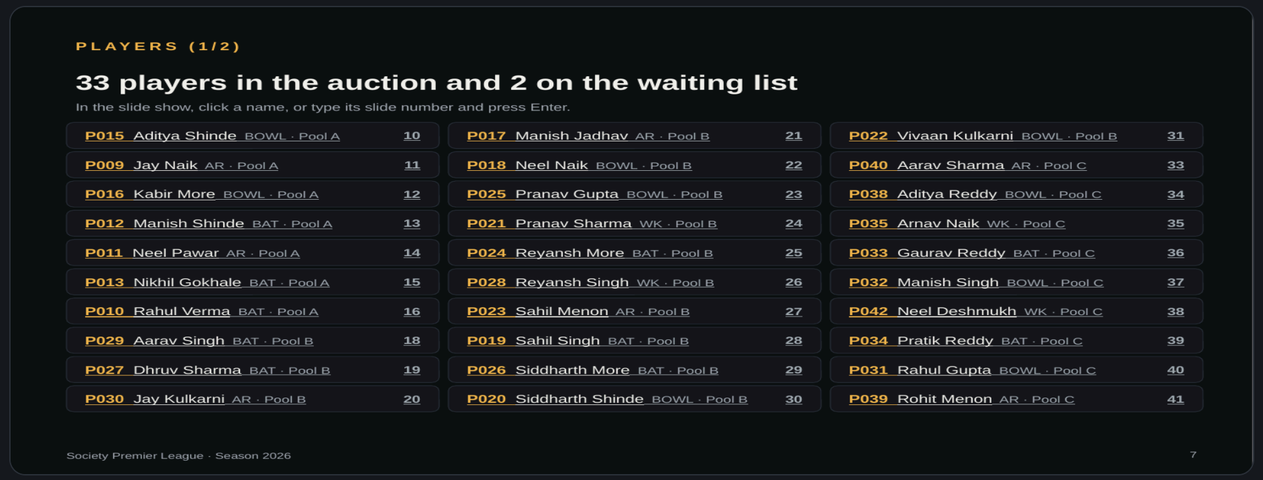
Gavel and confetti

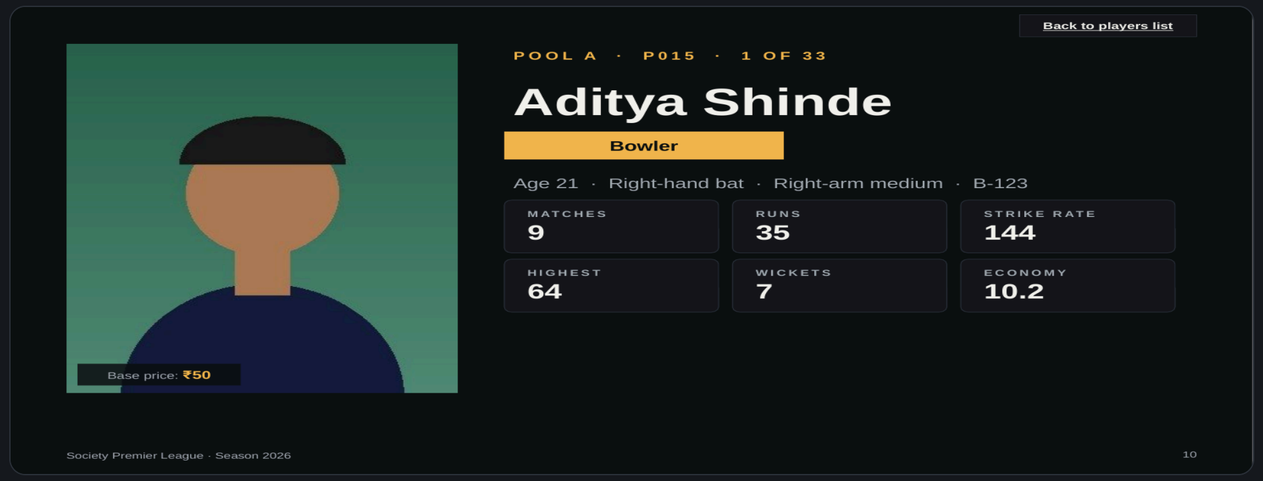
On the stage, with phones joining in. **Click the stage screen once** so the browser allows sound. Switch off in the control room.

Commentary humour

Setup → **Commentary humour: High** (or Normal for just the facts). In English, Hinglish and Marathi: *"Bidding war between ROY and THU. ₹90. This is getting personal."* Jokes are about the auction and the money, never a person.

Slides and an Excel tracker, for manual mode





Slides (PowerPoint)

Players → **Slides**. Rules, bid steps, teams, a clickable players list with numbers, and one slide per player with a small base-price tag.

In the slide show, click a name, or type its slide number and Enter.

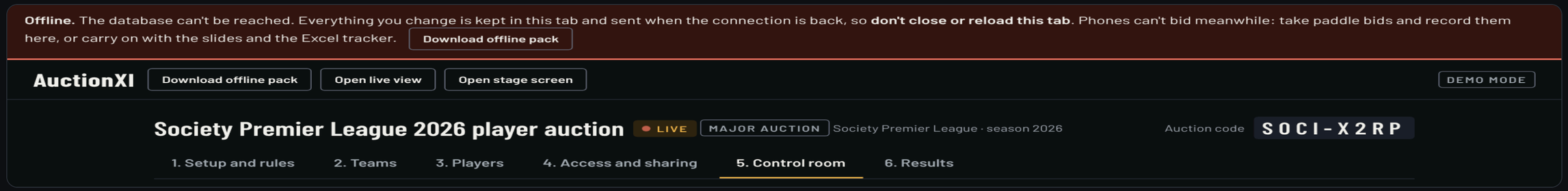
Offline tracker (Excel)

Players → **Offline tracker**. Type each sale in **Auction**; points left, still to buy and max bid update by the rules, and wrong entries turn red.

Live Auction for the big screen, **Find Player** by name or number, Ranking Board, one sheet per team.

Download both once the final players are in. Waiting-list players are included and marked; cancelled ones are left out.

Nothing is lost, and the auction carries on



Download offline pack

Top of the admin console, the offline banner and every error message. The Excel tracker **already filled in** with every sale and unsold player (purses, squads, max bids carry on from the next row), plus a backup file with everything.

Database offline

A red banner says so. Your changes stay in that tab and are sent when it's back: **don't close or reload it**. Phones can't bid meanwhile: take paddle bids, or carry on in the tracker.

AI limit or AI down

Every screen switches to the built-in commentary at once and AI is tried again after 1, 5 or 15 minutes, or with **Try AI now**.

Press Download offline pack every 10–15 sales so the laptop always has a recent copy.

Finish, publish, and plan next season



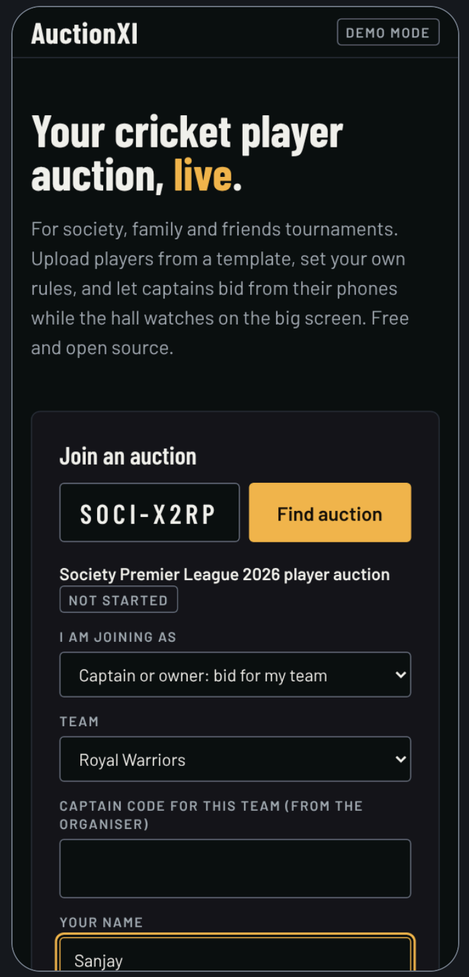
1. **Unsold players** come back after everyone has been up once, in the order they first came up.
2. **Finish** the auction: squads and prices go to the results page, online for good.
3. Download CSV or JSON; keep the results online permanently.
4. **Next season**: Results → mini auction. Tick who each team keeps; the rest go back to the pool.

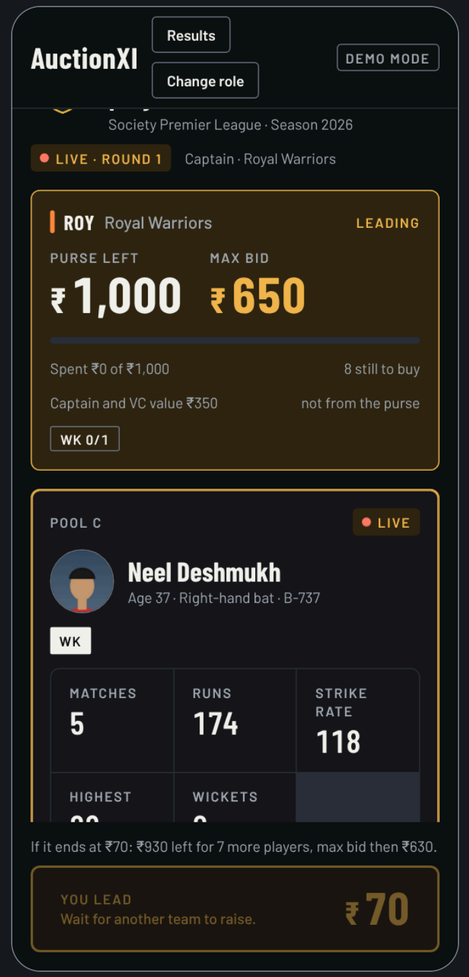
PART B

For captains

Join with your code, bid with one tap, and plan your budget in a private workbook that only you can read.

Your phone is your paddle





1. Open the auction link (or scan the QR), choose **Captain** and your team, and type **your code**.
2. At the top: your **points left** and **max bid**, always up to date.
3. Tap **BID** once for the next bid. The auctioneer confirms.
4. Above the button: what winning at that price leaves you, e.g. *₹830 left for 7 more players, max bid then ₹630*.
5. If you set your own max in the workbook, it warns when the next bid passes it.

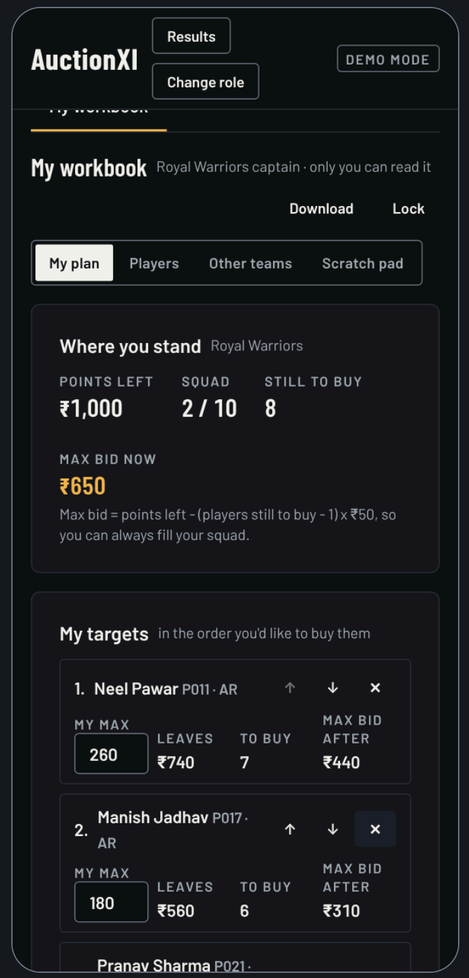
Private: locked with your PIN

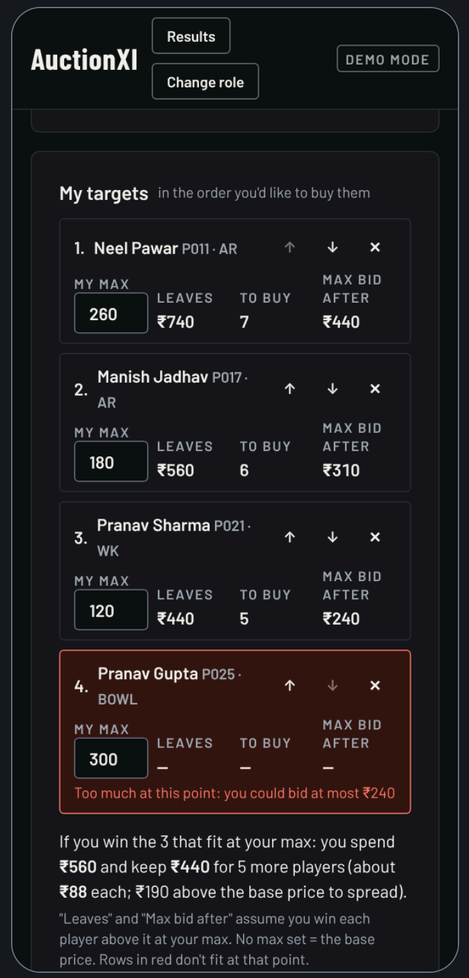


1. Open the **My workbook** tab and choose a PIN (4 or more digits).
2. Everything in it is **encrypted on your phone** before it is saved. Not the admin, not the organisers: only you can read it.
3. Four sections: **My plan**, **Players**, **Other teams**, **Scratch pad**.
4. **Lock** closes it at once; **Download** keeps a copy.

> A forgotten PIN cannot be recovered: you would start a new, empty workbook. The vice-captain has a separate workbook.

Your targets, your max bids, and what each buy leaves

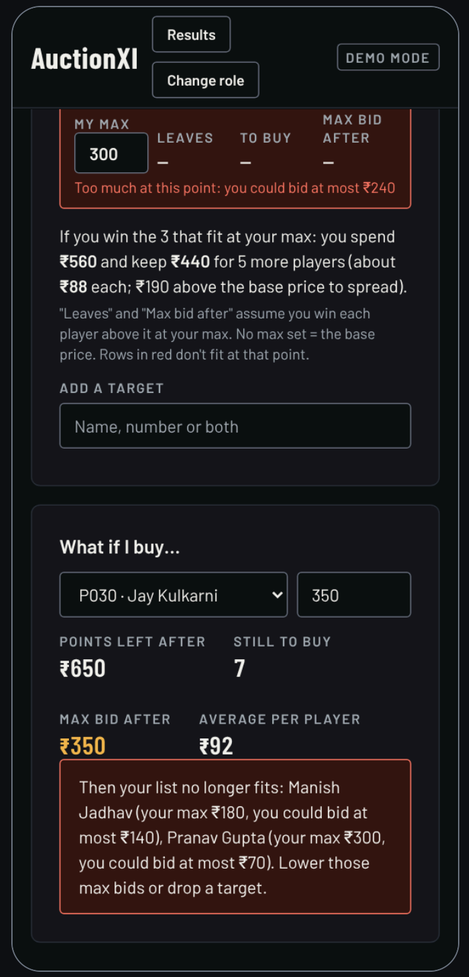


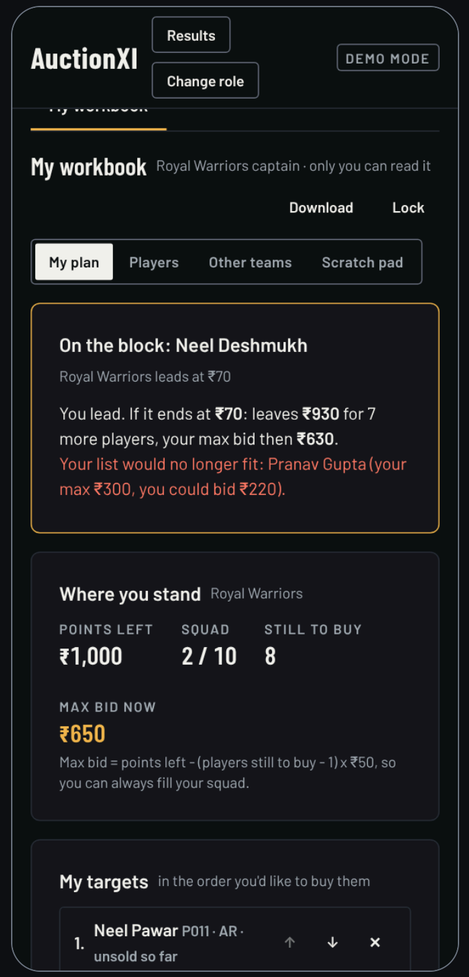


1. **Where you stand**: points left, squad, still to buy, max bid now.
2. **Add a target** by name or number, or "Add to list" in Players. Put them in order with ↑ ↓.
3. Type **My max** for each (blank = base price).
4. Each row shows what you would have **left** after winning it and the ones above, how many **to buy**, and your **max bid after**.
5. A **red row** no longer fits: the rules would not let you pay that much by then.

> The summary says what is left for the rest of your squad, about how much per player, and how much is spare above the base price.

Check a price before you bid





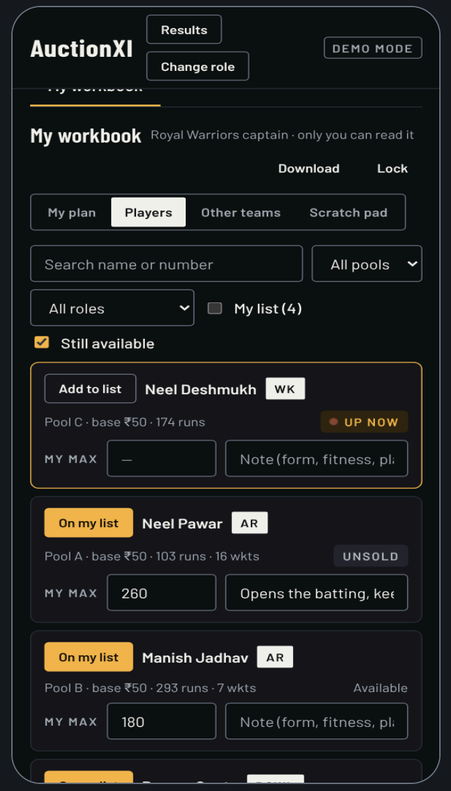
What if I buy...

Pick any available player and a price. You see points left, still to buy, max bid after and the average per remaining player, whether the rules allow that price, and which of your targets would then stop fitting.

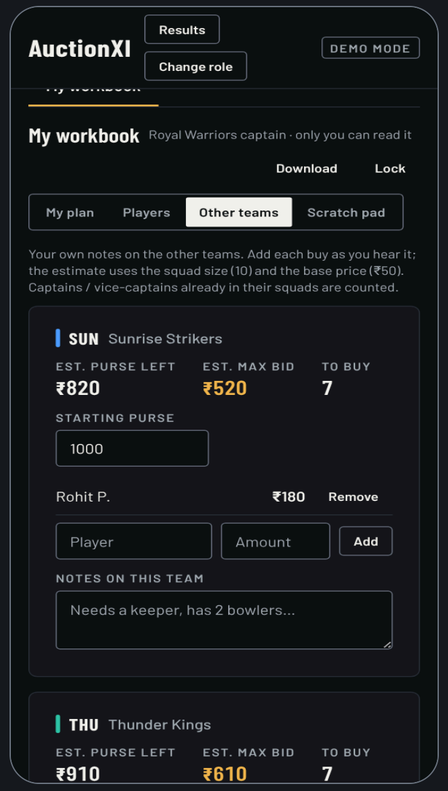
On the block

While a player is up, a gold card at the top shows what winning at the **next bid**, and at **your max**, would leave you, and which targets would no longer fit. When you lead, it shows the result if bidding ends at your bid.

Notes on everyone, and on your rivals



Players: search, filter by pool and role, add to your list, your max and a note



Other teams: note their buys; estimated purse left and max bid

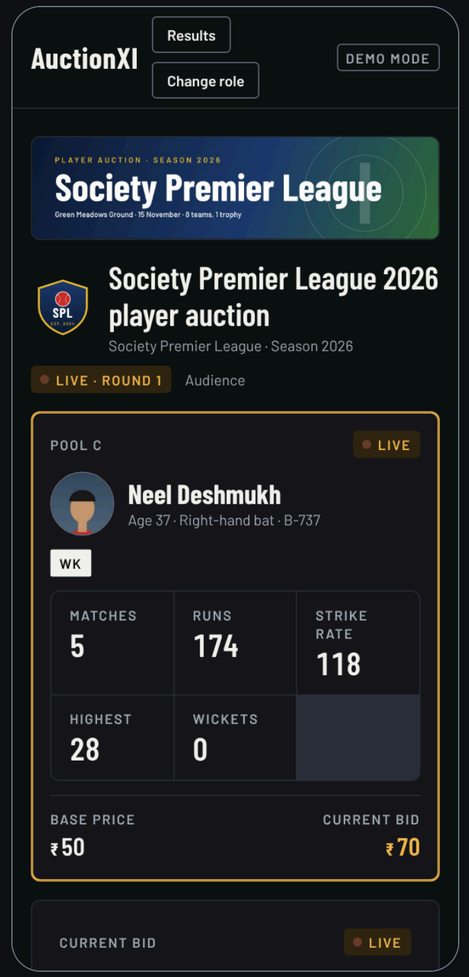


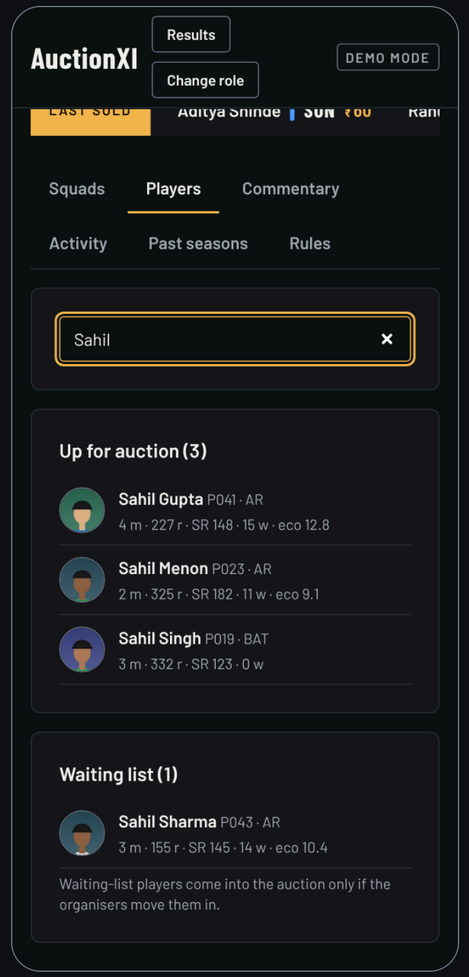
Scratch pad with a quick-sum calculator

Ask AI (optional)

With your own free AI key on your phone, ask things like "Which bowlers are still available for my points?". The AI sees your team, your list and the players left; nobody else sees the question or the answer.

Follow live and look anyone up





1. Open the auction link or type the auction code: no login, nothing to install.
2. Follow the player on the block, the bids, every team's squad and the commentary (English, Hinglish or Marathi; it can be read aloud).
3. **Players** tab: who is still up for auction and the waiting list, with full profiles. Search by name, number or both.
4. **Rules** tab: the tournament's rules and house rules.

The checklist

The day before

- Rules, teams and final players in; list **locked**
- Waiting list and cancelled registrations marked
- Photos, logo and banner uploaded
- Mock auction run with the captains, then reset or deleted
- Captain codes sent privately; visibility set to **Link** or **Listed**
- Slides and Excel tracker downloaded as a backup
- QR posters printed and pinned up

In the hall

- Laptop on power, control room open; co-admin on a second laptop
- Stage in full screen (`F11`), clicked once for the gavel; `V` for voice
- Captains joined and their workbooks open
- Chit bowl ready if drawing by chit
- Stage link shared on Zoom / Meet for those at home
- Download offline pack every 10–15 sales
- If the internet fails: carry on with the offline pack

AUCTIONXI

Let the bidding begin

Free and open source. Use it for your own tournaments, and send improvements back.

Site

pareshzawar.github.io/AuctionXI

Code and docs

github.com/pareshzawar/AuctionXI · docs/ · templates/

This guide

docs/guide/ in the repo, as PDF and PowerPoint